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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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Submitter Information

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General Comment

I appreciate the value of AI, and the value of the American AI industry, and believe that it is imperative to maintain the value of this critical and developing technology into the future. However, copyright laws have value, protecting the work of creatives and allowing them to profit off of their work, maintaining the cultural dominance of America in the global sphere regarding writing, music, and art, both digital and traditional. Allowing AI companies specifically to bypass these vital rules that protect creatives from small-time writers and indie filmmakers to the veritable titans of the industry such as Disney or Stephen King would be disastrous to America's cultural cache in the global sphere of art, and be financially ruinous to the vast majority of these creatives, replacing their product with a less-competent fake that can only make derivative works from their training data. If implemented, many creatives would suffer, America's economy would suffer, and America's global cultural dominance would suffer immensely. AI is an important burgeoning technology, but we need to look elsewhere to make AI a valuable technology than stripping creatives of the rights to their work to allow large tech companies to create a competitor that cannot compete in quality but rather in cost in flagrant violation of the history of copyright law as it has stood. Not only is this the incorrect strategic decision to maximize cultural output, it is also ignorant to the history of copyright law in the United States. If artificial intelligence companies wish to have access to the creative works of artists in the US, they should be required to individually ask for permission as every other interested party has had to do from the introduction of copyright law in the modern world, and if this is not viable, then they should find another means of producing a viable product that can enhance the quality of life of Americans rather than strip it away by making it more difficult to access art from American artists. I strongly urge that the implementation of this policy be reconsidered and immediately halted.